

David Beckham: Football Superstar And Global Glamour Icon [B2]

È stato uno dei calciatori più vincenti e amati di sempre, con titoli in quattro Paesi diversi. La sua fama, unita a prestigiose collaborazioni commerciali, gli ha fruttato milioni e lo ha reso un'icona globale.



David Beckham is one of the most famous footballers in history. He is the only player to win league titles in four different countries: England, Spain, France and the US. His fame both [on and off the pitch](#) means that he has transcended sport to become a British cultural icon and a global superstar.

A PASSION FOR FOOTBALL

Beckham was passionate about football from childhood. Every weekend he would be in the local park training alone or playing with his father for hours. He joined Manchester United as a youth [trainee](#) in 1991 at age fourteen and became part of the legendary Class of '92, which included other future stars such as Ryan Giggs, Gary Neville, and Paul Scholes. Beckham made his league debut as a midfielder four years later. On 17 August 1996, in the first game of the season, against Wimbledon, he scored an [astonishing](#) goal from [his own half](#). This 'golden goal' made Beckham a [household name](#). "It [kicked open the door](#) to the rest of my life", he said.

I never do anything [half-heartedly](#). I will continue to work hard and play hard and do everything I can to be successful, whatever I do.

SET-PIECE SPECIALIST

The player soon became known for his subtle passes, his [crosses](#) from the [wing](#), his ability to impose himself on games, and his sublime skill at scoring from [free kicks](#). His [curling strikes](#) were his [trademark](#). A perfect example was his goal in extra time against Greece in 2002, a twenty-seven-metre [curling](#) free kick, in the decisive qualifying game that sent England to the World Cup in Japan and South Korea. David, Victoria, and their eldest son, Brooklyn. With Beckham, Manchester United made football history, culminating in 1999, when they won the [treble](#): the Premier League, [FA Cup](#) and the Champions League. During these years, the club won the Premier League six times (five of which were consecutive), the [FA Cup](#) twice, the FA Charity [Shield](#) twice, and the Intercontinental Cup. Beckham was the highest-paid player in the world. Manager Sir Alex Ferguson, however, was unhappy with Beckham's off-pitch activities in the entertainment and advertising worlds, and sold the player to Real Madrid in 2003 for £25 million. That same year Beckham received an [OBE](#) for his services to football. People

England's Football Icon: Bobby Moore L'Inghilterra, culla del calcio, vanta diverse icone di questo sport. Fra queste, il calciatore di cui vi parliamo non eccelleva per abilità o talento, bensì per la determinazione, la costanza e il temperamento tranquillo. Daniel Francis , Conor Gleeson

FOREIGN CLUBS

Beckham would spend the second half of his career in Spain, the US, and France. He spent four seasons with Real Madrid, as one of the ‘Galácticos’, referring to the era of mega-star [signings](#), winning the La Liga title in his final year. Real Madrid exploited Beckham’s fame and marketing appeal: the Spanish club made \600 million in merchandise sales. In 2007, Beckham signed a five-year contract with America’s Major League [Soccer](## "calcio") club LA Galaxy. It proved a historic moment for football in the US, creating enormous interest in the sport. Film and TV celebrities frequently attended his games. Beckham also spent two seasons in Italy with AC Milan, and five months with Paris Saint-Germain in early 2013, where he gave his \5 million salary to a local children’s charity.

The only time you [run out](#) of [chances](#) is when you stop [taking](#) them.

FOOTBALL ROYALTY

Beckham’s global fame came not just from his footballing skills. An astute businessman, his name has become a [trademark](#), worth millions in clothes lines and fragrances. He is [conside](#)red a style icon and is always on the world’s best-dressed list. Part of his celebrity is [due to](#) his marriage in 1999 to Victoria Adams, [Posh](#) Spice from The Spice Girls, who is now a renowned fashion designer. The couple have made hundreds of millions from the [retail](#) and entertainment industries. In 2003, for example, Beckham signed a \$160-million lifetime contract with Adidas. His [embrace](#) of the world of brand partnerships has made him a celebrity superstar. As a sports journalist put it, “His brand is global, his appeal universal.” World

Vocabolario inglese sul calcio: 103 parole che ogni appassionato della Premier League dovrebbe conoscere Tutti i termini più comuni del calcio in inglese, per poterli urlare a squarciagola allo stadio. Julia Nigmatullina David Beckham is shown the red card during a France ‘98 World Cup match.

INTERNATIONAL CAREER

David Beckham also had a stellar international career. He made his England debut in September 1996, aged twenty-one. He won 115 [caps](#) representing England and captained the [side](#) fifty-nine times over a period of six years, scoring seventeen goals. He appeared in three World Cups, in 1998, 2002, and 2006. But playing international football gave him the worst experience of his life. In the 1998 World Cup, playing against Argentina, he was [fouled](#) by Diego Simeone and [retaliated](#) by [kicking out](#). Simeone “fell like a ton of [bricks](#)” (Sports Illustrated) and Beckham got a red card. Simeone later admitted that he was trying to get Beckham [sent off](#) by over-reacting. Britain’s tabloid press [viciously](#) attacked Beckham (the Daily

Mirror printed a [dartboard](#) with his face), and the player received death threats from the public and bullets in the post. Victoria Beckham later said that her husband became “clinically depressed” after receiving the red card.

WIDELY RESPECTED

Unexpectedly modest, despite his [achievements](#), Beckham once described his career with the sentence: “I just want people to see me as a hardworking footballer.” In his autobiography, Manchester United manager Sir Alex Ferguson was open with his praise: “From [the moment he first laid boot on ball](#), David Beckham displayed an unbreakable [urge](#) to make the best of himself and his talent.” Beckham’s colleague Nicky Butt said he was “as mentally tough as anybody you’ll ever meet.” Beckham suffers from obsessive compulsive disorder, and he has to have everything at home (such as food products or clothes) in straight lines or in pairs. From his playing years, he has kept a thousand pairs of boots in storage! Memories mean a lot to the footballer. Beckham has supported charities most of his life. He has worked with UNICEF for twenty years as a [Goodwill](#) Ambassador, promoting and protecting the rights of vulnerable children around the world. In 2015 he launched the 7 Fund with UNICEF to give disadvantaged children the opportunity to reach their full potential. He says: “My charity work gives me the most pleasure out of anything that I do.”

Glossary

- **kicking out** = dare un calcio
- **astonishing** = sorprendente
- **kicked open the door** = sfondare le porte
- **Shield** = trofeo
- **Goodwill** = buona volontà
- **Soccer** = calcio
- **embrace** = accettazione, adozione
- **caps** = presenze internazionali
- **side** = squadra
- **the moment he first laid boot on ball** = da quando ha iniziato a calciare il pallone
- **urge** = desiderio
- **crosses** = cross
- **free kicks** = calci di punizione
- **curling** = ad effetto
- **retaliated** = reagire, vendicarsi
- **dartboard** = bersaglio
- **achievements** = risultati, traguardi
- **on and off the pitch** = dentro e fuori dal campo
- **household name** = nome noto
- **strikes** = tiri
- **trademark** = marchio di fabbrica
- **treble** = tripletta
- **retail** = vendita al dettaglio
- **sent off** = espellere
- **bricks** = mattoni
- **his own half** = la propria metà campo
- **wing** = fascia, ala
- **OBE** = ufficiale dell'Ordine dell'Impero Britannico (Officer of the Order of the British Empire)
- **run out** = esaurire
- **due to** = dovuta a
- **FA Cup** = Coppa d'Inghilterra
- **chances** = opportunità
- **fouled** = commettere un fallo
- **viciously** = aggressivamente
- **trainee** = allievo, apprendista
- **half-heartedly** = controvoglia, senza entusiasmo
- **signings** = ingaggi
- **taking** = provarci, cogliere un'opportunità

- **Posh** = snob, chic